CAN SOCIAL WORK BE A HIGH-PAYING JOB?

By Dr Pekham Basu, *assistant professor, Centre for Equity and Justice for Children & Families, School of Social Work, Tata Institute of Social Sciences, Mumbai*

Social work is a profession for the **bravehearts who want to ignite a change in the world** and leave a legacy behind. It is an academic discipline that is focused on working with humanity. Social work is for self-driven individuals with a passion for social innovation and changing the lives of the marginalised sections of society. Service is key, with humble beginnings and gradual rise

Social workers often get placed in not-for-profit organisations where they directly work with communities on issues ranging from individual to societal problems. It is **an international degree, and one can choose to work abroad** and earn in foreign currency after acquiring the licence to work in a particular country. This can be as a professional social worker in the government system or in an international agency. Graduates are often employed in multilateral agencies like the United Nations

In India, employment with **any company's corporate social responsibility (CSR) wing** is a popular placement option, where degree holders can contribute meaningfully along with earning a good pay package, starting from Rs 12 lakh per annum. On average, a fresh social work post-graduate from TISS, with no prior work experience or other higher education degree, takes home a lucrative salary of Rs 50,000 per month. Social research is also an important skill that helps students work in domestic and international think tanks. Many choose to join the government as civil servants or in government agencies and programmes like the NITI Aayog, National Rural Livelihood Mission, National Skill Development Corporation and so on. Many students with prior professional experience also join at mid-career levels

Establishing new social ventures is not alien to social work students since a master's degree in social work from TISS guarantees the quality and commitment that venture capitalists look for. Above all, it gives the **opportunity to explore the 'self' and society**, making a robust professional who can make a difference in any continent, irrespective of the sector and organisation. So, enrol for a degree that allows you to do good, reach for the sky and get paid!

TOP 10 EMERGING COLLEGES

Highest-scoring colleges among those set up in and after 2000

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY
1	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, CHRIST (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY)	Bengaluru
2	KRISTU JAYANTI COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Bengaluru
3	MSW PROGRAM, PRASANNA SCHOOL OF PUBLIC HEALTH, MAHE	Manipal
4	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL WORK, SCHOOL OF SOCIAL SCIENCES, CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF RAJASTHAN	Ajmer
5	AMITY INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES	Noida
6	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIOLOGY, BANASTHALI VIDYAPITH	Banasthali Vidyapith, Rajasthan
7	ST. JOSEPH'S COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Bengaluru
8	ST. ALOYSIUS COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Mangaluru
9	THE BHOPAL SCHOOL OF SOCIAL SCIENCES	Bhopal
10	S.S. JAIN SUBODH P.G. COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Jaipur

NEW ENTRANTS

Colleges that feature among top 25 for the first time

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY
20	KARVE INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL SERVICE	Pune